STRATEGY

Read the axes, not the dots.

Most people use the Magic Quadrant to pick a vendor. I use it as a strategy tool. Here is how.



Top right is still the target. But how do you get there?

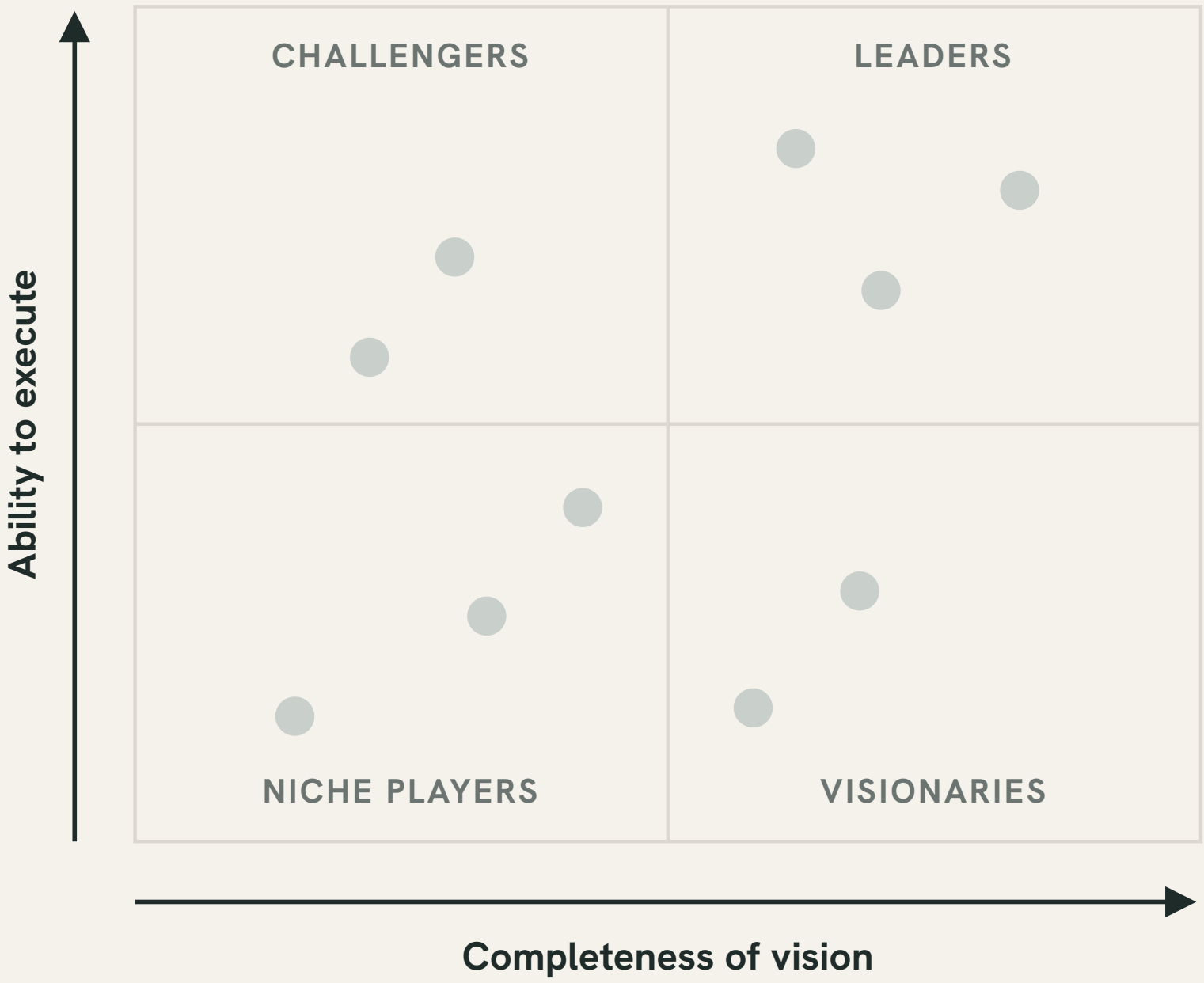
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HÅKAN NILSSON

THE MODEL

Everyone wants the top right.

The Magic Quadrant is a key reference when much of the industry buys software and services. As a buyer, you want to buy from a leader. And because of that, vendors want to be in the top right too.



Fair enough. But the good stuff is the axes.

THE AXES

The two axes work far beyond buying software.

Gartner breaks both axes into criteria for vendors. Do the same for your product team or domain, and you have a surprisingly strong strategy tool.

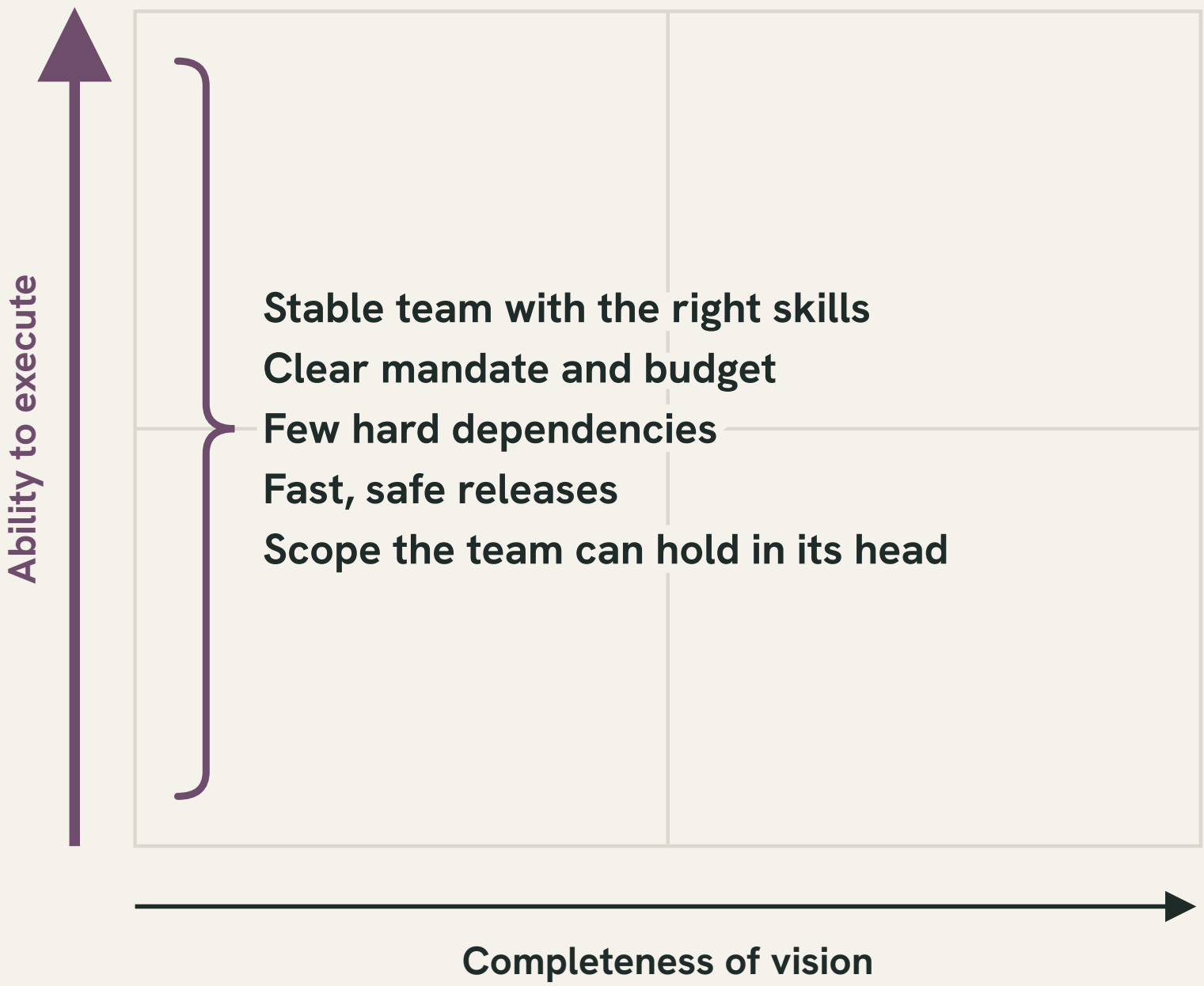


AXIS 1 · EXECUTION

Ability to execute

What gives us, as a product team or a domain, the ability to execute?

Gartner has its own list, for vendors. This is mine, for a product team.



Yours might look different. Think of them as your car…

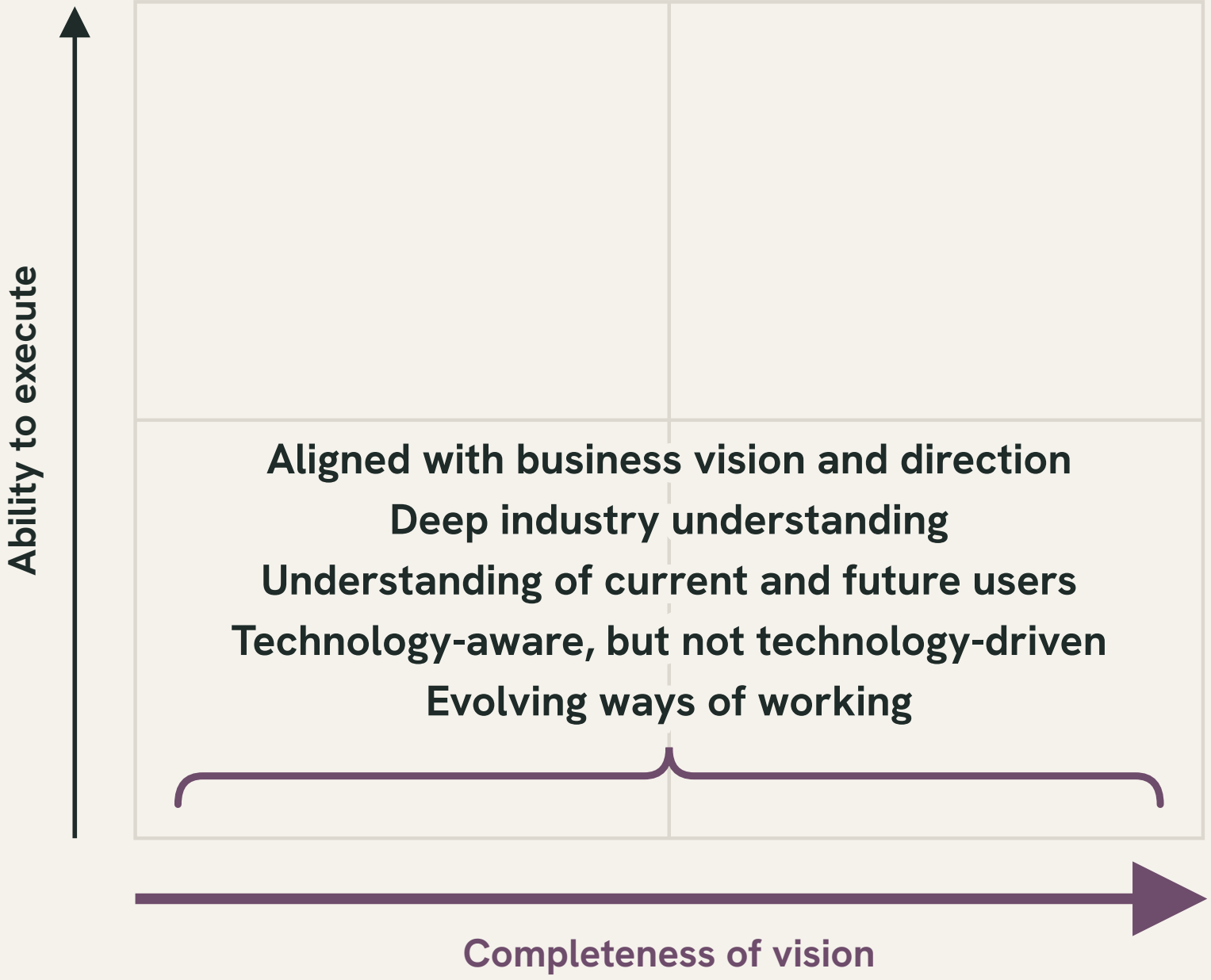
 Source: Gartner, Magic Quadrant methodology

AXIS 2 · VISION

Completeness of vision

Where do we need to go to make our users happy in a way that works for our business?

Gartner has its own list, for vendors. This is mine, for a product team.



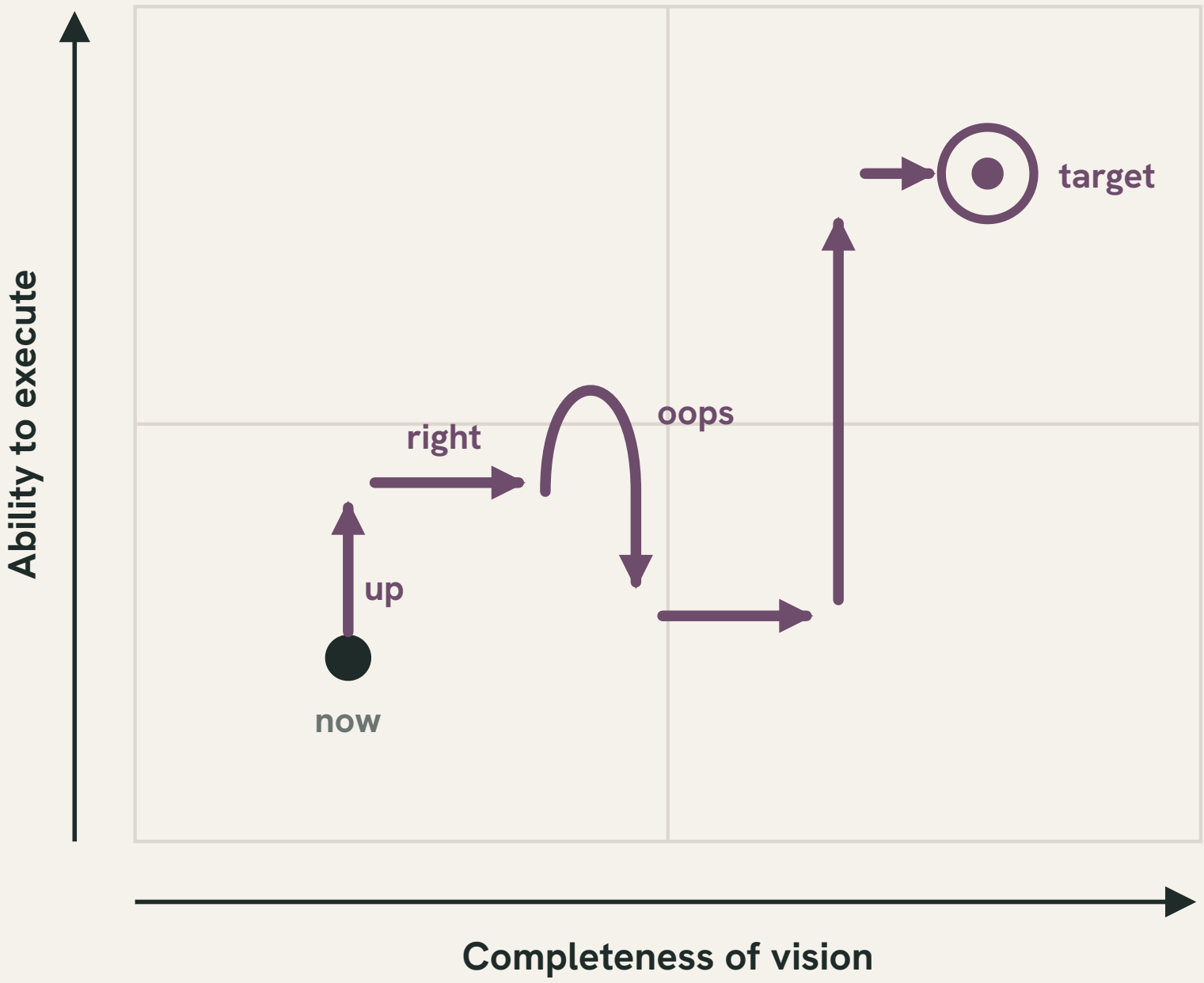
Again, yours might be different, think of them as your destination.

 Source: Gartner, Magic Quadrant methodology

YOUR MOVE

Measure where you are. Then choose your move.

Every move costs resources and attention. A step up may mean no step right.

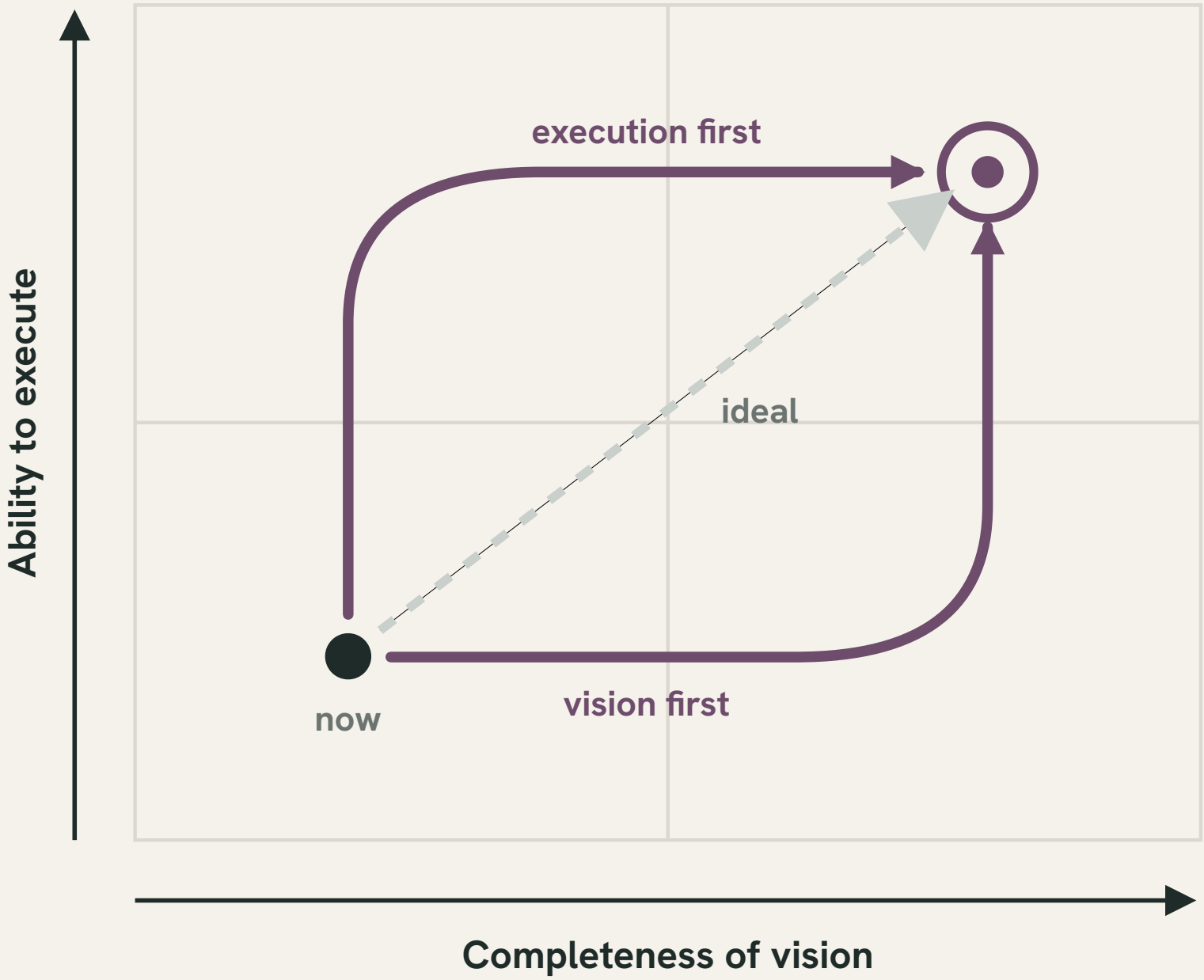


Up or right? What comes first?

IN REALITY

Strategy is often drawn as a straight arrow.

That is rare in reality. The path you choose *is* the strategy.



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